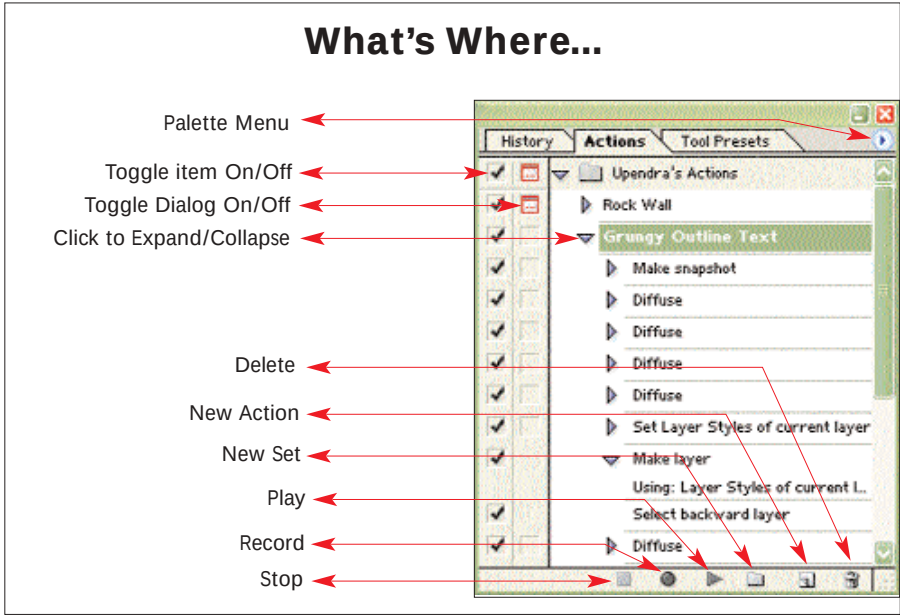
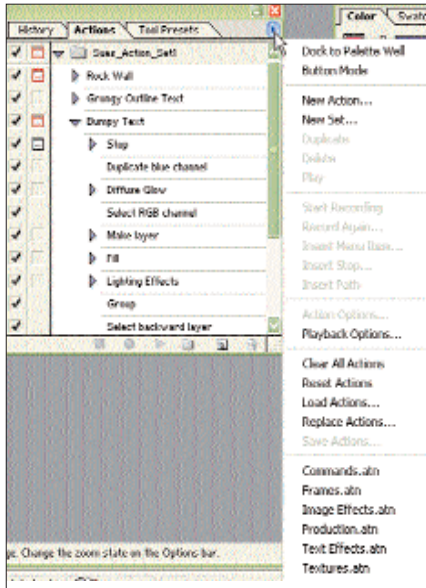




the filename, else all files you run the action on will be saved with the exact same filename.

Cut!

If you want to apply a particular command to only a selected area of an image, you can use actions by inserting a Stop. You can insert a Stop while recording an action or even after it is recorded. When the action is applied, it will stop and allow you make changes, such as using the Paint Brush, adjusting the Hue and saturation, etc. You can then continue the action by pressing Play.



The Palette menu is the place you will find most of the commands to create, edit and play actions

To insert a Stop while recording an action, click the triangle at top right-hand corner of the Actions palette and choose 'Insert Stop...' from menu that pops up. Enter a message that you want to be displayed. If you want to allow yourself to continue the action without doing anything, check the 'Allow Continue' checkbox. Now, click OK to continue recording the action.

Fine tuning...

In the Actions palette, you will see two icons to the left of every step. The first is a checkmark that shows that this particular command will be executed when the action containing it is played. In case you want to execute only selected commands of a particular action, unselected the commands you don't want to execute by clicking this icon. The icon next to the check mark shows whether the command is a modal command or not. When a modal command is reached, the action is paused and a dialog box pops up, asking you for permission. The most common example will be the Stop command. This icon is very useful when you want to make your action more flexible. For example, suppose you are recording an action. At one point, you adjust the colour balance. Now every time the action is played, the same values of colour are used. But every image is different, and there is usually a need for different parameters. In this case, you need to enable the dialog box for that command. To do that, simply click on modal icon in the palette. Now the dialog box will wait for you to enter the values before continuing with the rest of the action.

Using Snapshots

Often you may apply an action to a file and be dissatisfied with the results. The history palette keeps track of only the last 20 commands. So if you want to revert to something you did 20 commands ago, you'll need a little help. Always take a Snapshot of the image before applying an action.

The Snapshot command make a temporary copy of any state of the



Use Snapshots to revert to any state of your image

image. To revert to the previous state, just click the name of the Snapshot that you want to revert to. You can also create duplicate images for any snapshot.

One problem with actions is that they don't record painting and toning tools, tool options, view commands and window commands. However, many of these can be inserted using the 'Insert Menu Item'. To do this, select 'Insert Menu Item' from the Actions palette menu. Now, with the dialog box open, choose the command you want to insert from its menu. Click OK. Unlike other commands, this one is not executed while recording; it will be executed only when the action is played. Also, if a command that opens a dialog box is inserted, you cannot disable the modal control from the Actions palette.

Piecing it all together

Once you've recorded and customised your actions, it's time to put them to the test. Simply open a file, select the action you want to play by clicking on it and click Play. You can also choose Play from the palette menu; If you assigned a shortcut key at the time of recording the action, you can use that as well.

You can use actions to execute a list of commands, but what if you only want one or some of the commands listed under the action? To execute a single command from